

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 52)

Page 257 - Thomas Hardy's Genius

Q1. What prevents Jude the Obscure from being the greatest of Hardy's novels according to the text?

- A. Its lack of detailed character descriptions
- B. The characters' lack of spiritual resilience and inability to stand erect and hit destiny full in the face
- C. Its setting outside of Wessex
- D. The complete lack of humor

Answer: B

Q2. What advice did George Meredith give the young Thomas Hardy regarding his first unpublished novel?

- A. To focus more on poetry
- B. To give more attention to plot
- C. To abandon rural settings
- D. To write shorter novels

Answer: B

Q3. What negative consequence arose from Hardy taking Meredith's advice too literally?

- A. His characters became one-dimensional
- B. He ceased writing descriptions of nature
- C. He often disregarded probability and trusted overmuch in coincidence
- D. His dialogue became stilted

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Answer: C

Q4. Hardy's power to suggest immensity of place was unique; what is described as the dour vastness in *The Return of the Native*?

- A. Blackmoor Vale
- B. Egdon Heath
- C. The Woodlanders
- D. Exmoor

Answer: B

Q5. On Egdon Heath, how are the men and women portrayed in relation to the Heath?

- A. As giants mastering their environment
- B. As pigmies, while the Heath itself is the demon moulding their lives
- C. As completely independent of the landscape
- D. As supernatural beings

Answer: B

Q6. In the use of what element does Hardy bear comparison with the great figures in world literature, though falling short by pursuing it past natural limits?

- A. Comedy
- B. Epic verse
- C. Tragedy

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D. Political satire

Answer: C

Q7. However, in the use of what is Hardy unsurpassed, as seen in Tess's christening of her child?

A. Pathos (the exquisite handling of sorrow)

B. Sarcasm

C. Historical accuracy

D. Picaresque adventure

Answer: A

Q8. Hardy was painfully dissatisfied with the age in which he lived and was homesick for what?

A. The future utopia

B. The past of England before education and culture overlaid strong roots

C. The Renaissance period

D. Ancient Greece

Answer: B

Q9. What did Hardy suspect the effect of modern civilization was on people with stout hearts and clear heads?

A. To improve them immensely

B. To decivilize and weaken them

C. To make them deeply religious

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D. To turn them into artists

Answer: B

Q10. What is constantly at war in Hardy's books, where those who feel the alienating touch of school-bred refinement are never happy?

A. The upper class and the lower class

B. Ancient and modern

C. Men and women

D. England and France

Answer: B

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Page 258 - Hardy's Philosophy and The Dynasts

Q1. Beneath the Christian veneer in Wessex, Hardy thought gratefully of the lingering presence of what?

- A. Roman Catholicism
- B. Simple paganism
- C. Protestant work ethic
- D. Stoic philosophy

Answer: B

Q2. What did Wessex signify as a symbol in relation to Hardy's whole work?

- A. A noble antiquity making mute protest against invading aggressive modernity
- B. The triumph of industrial progress
- C. A completely fictional fantasy land
- D. A model for future urban development

Answer: A

Q3. Resenting the animosity stirred by Tess and Jude, what did Hardy abandon in 1896?

- A. Poetry
- B. Architecture
- C. Novel-writing
- D. Living in Wessex

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Answer: C

Q4. Which 1898 collection included Hardy's poem 'Hap', showing his unchanging idea of the ordering of the universe?

- A. The Dynasts
- B. Wessex Poems
- C. The Return of the Native
- D. Poems of the Past and the Present

Answer: B

Q5. In what massive work did Hardy's idea of the universe reach its final expression?

- A. The Dynasts
- B. Jude the Obscure
- C. The Way of All Flesh
- D. The Testament of Beauty

Answer: A

Q6. What did Hardy believe was behind human destiny instead of an active intelligence or loving God?

- A. A council of gods
- B. Purely human agency
- C. An unconscious mechanical force, sightless, dumb, and mindless
- D. A benevolent nature spirit

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Answer: C

Q7. What is the blind and senseless force called in *The Dynasts* that might one day 'fashion all things fair'?

- A. The Absolute
- B. The Immanent Will
- C. The Great Spirit
- D. The Prime Mover

Answer: B

Q8. What historical event is the subject of *The Dynasts*, an epic-drama completed in 1908?

- A. The English Civil War
- B. The Norman Conquest
- C. The Napoleonic wars
- D. The Crimean War

Answer: C

Q9. What two traditional forms did Hardy adapt and combine to produce a new and original form in *The Dynasts*?

- A. The lyric and the essay
- B. The epic and the drama
- C. The novel and the sermon
- D. The sonnet and the tragedy

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Answer: B

Q10. What replaces extended passages of narrative verse in The Dynasts to fill the spaces between scenes?

- A. Blank verse monologues
- B. Prose historical summaries
- C. Vivid 'stage-directions'
- D. Choral odes

Answer: C

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Page 259 - Poets of the Transition (1892-1913)

Q1. How did Hardy feel toward the suffering caused by the clash of dynasts?

- A. He was indifferent
- B. He had terribly acute pity and agonized in the agony of others
- C. He thought it was necessary for progress
- D. He viewed it strictly as a historian

Answer: B

Q2. What protective skin was Hardy never able to cultivate?

- A. The skin of semi-apologetic callousness that insulates against participation in the world's misery
- B. A sense of humor
- C. Literary confidence
- D. Political allegiance

Answer: A

Q3. Four years after Tennyson's death, upon whom did the laureateship decline?

- A. William Watson
- B. Alfred Austin
- C. W. E. Henley
- D. Rudyard Kipling

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Answer: B

Q4. How is Alfred Austin described in the text?

- A. A major philosophical poet
- B. A brilliant satirist
- C. A political journalist capable of little more than sentimental balderdash in verse
- D. The voice of a new generation

Answer: C

Q5. What were the keywords for the first group of poets in the transition period (1892-1913)?

- A. Art and beauty
- B. Patriotism and imperialism
- C. Decadence and symbolism
- D. Science and progress

Answer: B

Q6. Which editor and critic fostered the talent of young writers in the Scots Observer and National Observer?

- A. William Watson
- B. W. E. Henley
- C. Alfred Austin
- D. Robert Bridges

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Answer: B

Q7. For which poem, a piece of spectacular fist-shaking against heaven, is W. E. Henley more widely admired?

- A. The Purple East
- B. Invictus
- C. Wordsworth's Grave
- D. For England's Sake

Answer: B

Q8. Who would have justified the poet laureate's function with dignity had he been appointed to succeed Tennyson?

- A. W. E. Henley
- B. Alfred Noyes
- C. William Watson
- D. Alfred Austin

Answer: C

Q9. Which of the following is an elegy written by William Watson on the death of Tennyson?

- A. Lyra Heroica
- B. The Purple East
- C. Lachrymae Musarum

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D. In Memoriam

Answer: C

Q10. What did William Watson's patriotic lyrics and occasional poems generally show, except when indignation betrayed him?

A. A sense of order and proportion

B. Absolute chaos

C. Free verse experimentation

D. Deep philosophical pessimism

Answer: A

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Page 260 - Kipling, Noyes, and Thompson

Q1. Opinions on whose verse are described as still being in a fluid state, with some accounting him impressive and others exasperated?

- A. W. E. Henley
- B. Rudyard Kipling
- C. Alfred Noyes
- D. William Watson

Answer: B

Q2. What impression do Kipling's soldier tales and poems succeed in giving?

- A. A strictly cynical view of war
- B. Precisely the modestly heroic impression of the British soldier that the nation loved
- C. A highly romanticized fantasy
- D. An intellectual critique of imperialism

Answer: B

Q3. Which poet, born in 1880, provides immediate pleasure with tunefulness and pictorial emphasis, though some question his permanence?

- A. Alfred Noyes
- B. Robert Bridges
- C. Francis Thompson

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D. A. E. Housman

Answer: A

Q4. Which three poets of this transition period are said to stand apart from the rest?

A. Henley, Watson, and Kipling

B. Thompson, Housman, and Bridges

C. Wilde, Symonds, and Dowson

D. Austin, Noyes, and Davidson

Answer: B

Q5. Which poet's life was a tangled comi-tragedy of invertebrate will, drugs, penury, and imaginative splendour?

A. A. E. Housman

B. Francis Thompson

C. Robert Bridges

D. Ernest Dowson

Answer: B

Q6. Who rescued Francis Thompson from match-selling in the London gutters?

A. Oscar Wilde

B. Wilfrid and Alice Meynell

C. Thomas Hardy

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D. Robert Bridges

Answer: B

Q7. Which famous poem by Francis Thompson is unique for its metaphysical import and magnificently opulent diction?

A. A Shropshire Lad

B. The Hound of Heaven

C. The Testament of Beauty

D. Ode to the Setting Sun

Answer: B

Q8. What does The Hound of Heaven reveal incandescently?

A. The implacable pursuing love of God

B. The inevitability of death

C. The beauty of nature

D. The terror of the French Revolution

Answer: A

Q9. What caused Francis Thompson to use words in a manner that gives them the effect of gorgeous vestments at a solemn ritual?

A. His modernism

B. His classicism

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C. His medievalism

D. His romanticism

Answer: C

Q10. In other moods, how could Francis Thompson write without relaxing emotional intensity?

A. Delicately simple (as in some poems on children)

B. Harshly satirical

C. Deeply pessimistic

D. Strictly narrative

Answer: A

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Page 261 - Housman and Bridges

Q1. Which poet published only two small books of verse, A Shropshire Lad and Last Poems?

- A. Robert Bridges
- B. Francis Thompson
- C. A. E. Housman
- D. W. E. Henley

Answer: C

Q2. What characterizes A. E. Housman's philosophic stance in his poetry?

- A. Joyous optimism
- B. Adamantine fortitude of philosophic pessimism
- C. Christian mysticism
- D. Scientific materialism

Answer: B

Q3. Housman's art consisted in that most difficult of literary exercises, described as what?

- A. Ruthless pruning without denuding
- B. Writing epic poetry in prose
- C. Creating complex symbolic systems
- D. Writing without any emotional content

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Answer: A

Q4. What did Housman's philosophy encourage the utter abandonment of?

- A. Classical form
- B. Hope and self-pity, substituting nothing but endurance
- C. Rural imagery
- D. Metrical regularity

Answer: B

Q5. Housman is the distinction of being the first English poet of importance to shed religious belief without being what?

- A. Proud of himself or sorry for himself
- B. Attacked by critics
- C. Involved in politics
- D. Sent to prison

Answer: A

Q6. What profession did Robert Bridges practice until he was nearly forty?

- A. Lawyer
- B. Architect
- C. Surgeon
- D. Soldier

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Answer: C

Q7. Between 1885 and 1905, what did Robert Bridges write that were entirely neglected by the theatres?

- A. Epics
- B. Novels
- C. Verse-dramas and masques
- D. Political pamphlets

Answer: C

Q8. In what year was Robert Bridges appointed Poet Laureate?

- A. 1892
- B. 1905
- C. 1913
- D. 1929

Answer: C

Q9. What lengthy philosophical poem did Bridges publish at the end of 1929?

- A. The Testament of Beauty
- B. The Growth of Love
- C. Eros and Psyche
- D. The Dynasts

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Answer: A

Q10. How was The Testament of Beauty received, despite being much more difficult than his earlier poems?

- A. It was largely ignored
- B. It was received with general admiration
- C. It was heavily criticized for its form
- D. It was banned

Answer: B